

Χίωνος Ἐπιστολαί

Chion of Heraclea Letters and the Fiction of Tyrannicide

eul_aid: otm

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)
Domain: Μυθιστορία [Fiction](#)
Format: Ἐπιστολή [Epistle](#)

Chion of Heraclea is a pseudonym attached to a collection of fictional letters composed in the 1st or 2nd century CE. The letters are presented as the work of Chion of Heraclea, a student of Plato who assassinated the tyrant Clearchus in 353/2 BCE, but they are a later Roman-era literary creation. No historical author named Chion is attested.

The sole work is the **Letters**, a collection of seventeen fictional epistles surviving in full. They are pseudepigraphically attributed to the historical tyrannicide Chion.

The **Letters of Chion** constitute the only complete Greek epistolary novel preserved from antiquity. As a key example of the "tyrannicide" genre, the work reflects the Roman-era reception of Platonic philosophy and the idealized philosopher, while exemplifying contemporary literary tastes for rhetorical and pseudepigraphical fiction.

Works (1)

- Ἐπιστολαὶ πρὸς Μάτριν · [Letters to Matris](#) · 46 passages